Lesson plan · for the teacher

Updates close the door

Cyber security · Level 2 · Lesson 1

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk; A green and a red card for each pupil (or squares of paper); Six situations written on a sheet for the teacher

Learning goals

- Explain what a security update fixes.
- Decide when it is safe and sensible to install an update.
- Spot software that is risky to install.

Activity: Update or not?: Green card, red card

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the story: the lock on the school store room is broken, and everyone in town has heard. Ask pupils: when should the school fix it, and why not next month?
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that apps have hidden mistakes, and some are holes. An update is the new lock. Once a fix is out, criminals study it and look for phones that haven't installed it. Draw a phone with a hole and a patch.
3. Green card, red card (15 min): Read the six situations one at a time. Pupils hold up green for safe or red for risky. Ask two pupils each time to explain their card.
4. Share (7 min): In groups, pupils write one short rule for the phones at home, such as "Let updates run at night on the charger." Groups read their rules aloud.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one thing an update does and one thing they won't install. Read a few aloud.

Write six situations on a sheet: an update offered during an exam; a phone whose security date is two years old; a cracked game from a friend; an app from a link in a chat; an update set for tonight on the charger; a "free full version" of a paid program. Cut a green and a red square of paper for each pupil.

Discussion

- Why do criminals study a new update?
- When is the best time for a phone to update?
- What would you do with a computer that no longer gets updates?

Exit ticket

- One thing an update does + one thing I won't install.

Try it in class tomorrow
Play "Update or not?": read out six short situations, such as an update offered during an exam, a phone that stopped getting fixes, a cracked game from a friend, an app from a link in a chat, an

update set for tonight on the charger, and a “modded” app. Pupils hold up a green card for safe and a red card for risky, and explain why.

Worksheet · for pupils

Updates close the door

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A colleague posts in the staff group: "Free full version of the timetable program, no licence needed!" Safe or risky?**

- ◯ Safe: a colleague shared it
- ◯ Risky: cracked software often hides malware
- ◯ Safe, if the antivirus doesn't complain

2 **Which of these keep a school phone protected?**

- ☐ Automatic updates for the system and the apps
- ☐ Restarting when the phone asks after an update
- ☐ Installing apps only from the official store
- ☐ Waiting a few months to see whether an update is safe
- ☐ Installing the "cleaner" app a pop-up recommends

3 **If a phone works fine, it doesn't need security updates.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

4 **Complete the sentences.**

A security update _____ a hole in the code. A device past its _____ date gets no more fixes, so keep it away from _____ .

Word bank: closes · opens · end-of-support · purchase · pupils' records · the charger

5 **Match each situation to the safest response.**

An update pops up in the middle of a lesson	• • • •	Scan it before opening any file
The phone's security date is two years old	• • • •	Don't install it; use the official store
A friend sends a "modded" app file	• • • •	Keep it off sensitive work and plan to replace it
A USB stick from the cyber café	• • • •	Let it run tonight on the charger

✎ **Think of the devices you use for school: your phone, a laptop, the office computer. Which one is most likely to be missing updates, and what will you do about it this week?**